Updated: Threat Actors Associated with the ShinyHunters Brand Expand Targeting of Cloud Applications for Extortion Operations

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Executive Summary

- In an incident spanning early to mid-January 2026, a threat actor likely used voice phishing (vishing) to obtain initial access to a victim's environment. They subsequently pivoted to various cloud platforms—including Google Workspace, Salesforce, Docusign, and Atlassian—and stole data used for ShinyHunters-branded extortion operations. Google Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) attributes the extortion activity to UNC6240.
- The threat actor also used access to a compromised email account to send additional phishing emails to contacts at crypto-focused companies.
- This recent incident represents an expansion in the number and type of targeted cloud platforms, suggesting that the associated threat actors are modifying their operations to gather more sensitive data for extortion operations.
- UNC6240 has impacted organizations operating in a wide range of industries and based in Canada, France, the UK, and the US; however, targeting is likely broader than directly observed[.]Indicators associated with this activity have been attached to this report. Also see **25-10043011** for mitigation strategies to combat vishing attacks.

Content

New Version Details

Version 2, Jan. 23, 2026: This report has been updated to highlight the emergence of a new ShinyHunters-branded data leak site (DLS) that may be listing victims impacted by these most recent extortion operations, as well as new reporting from Okta.

Google Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) is aware of multiple organizations responding to ShinyHunters-branded extortion incidents involving similar tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs). In an incident spanning early to mid-January 2026, a threat actor likely used voice phishing (vishing) to obtain initial access to a victim's environment. They subsequently pivoted to cloud resources and stole data used for ShinyHunters-branded extortion operations. Google Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) attributes the extortion activity to **UNC6240**, based on several overlaps, such as the use of the Tox account BD1B683FD3E6CB094341317A4C09923B7AE3E7903A6CDB90E5631EC7DC1452636FF35D9F5AF2 for negotiations, ShinyHunters-branded extortion emails, and Limewire to host samples of stolen data. The initial intrusion activity is still being analyzed; however, there are limited overlaps with activity previously attributed to **UNC6040**, such as the affiliation with UNC6240 and prior operations targeting Salesforce data via **Salesforce DATALOADER** (**CAMP.25.032**, **25-10025182**).

- In early January, a threat actor masquerading to be "from IT" called an employee at the victim organization, claiming that the company was updating multifactor authentication (MFA) settings and verified the employee's phone number. The threat actor subsequently registered their own device for MFA.
  - The threat actor also enabled the "ToggleBox Recall" add-on for Google Workspace, a tool designed to search for and permanently delete emails. They then deleted a "Security method enrolled" email from Okta, almost certainly to prevent the employee from identifying that their account was associated with a new MFA device.
  - Okta has **published** a report about phishing kits targeting Identity Providers and cryptocurrency platforms, as well as follow-on vishing attacks. While they associate this activity with multiple threat clusters, at least some of the activity appears to overlap with ShinyHunters-branded operations.
- After the threat actor gained access to the Okta account, they moved laterally through the victim's environment and accessed and exfiltrated data from software-as-a-service (SaaS) platforms, including Google Workspace, Salesforce, DocuSign, and Atlassian.
  - Preliminary analysis suggests that the threat actor targeted personally identifiable information (PII) stored in Salesforce. They also used Google Takeout to export Google account data.
- The threat actor also used access to a compromised email account to send additional phishing emails to contacts at cryptocurrency-focused companies, leveraging Calendly links as lures. GTIG has observed Calendly links used in other phishing emails targeting cryptocurrency entities, though it is currently unclear if those messages are part of the same activity set. The threat actor then deleted the outbound emails, likely in an attempt to obfuscate their malicious activity.
- In mid-January 2026, UNC6240 sent extortion emails outlining what data they allegedly stole, specifying a payment amount and destination BTC address, and threatening consequences if the ransom was not paid within 72 hours, which is consistent with prior extortion emails (Figure 1). They also provided "proof" of data theft via samples hosted on Limewire.
- A new ShinyHunters-branded data leak site (DLS) named "SHINYHUNTERS" has emerged listing several alleged victims who may have been compromised in these most recent extortion operations. The DLS also lists contact information that has previously been associated with UNC6240.

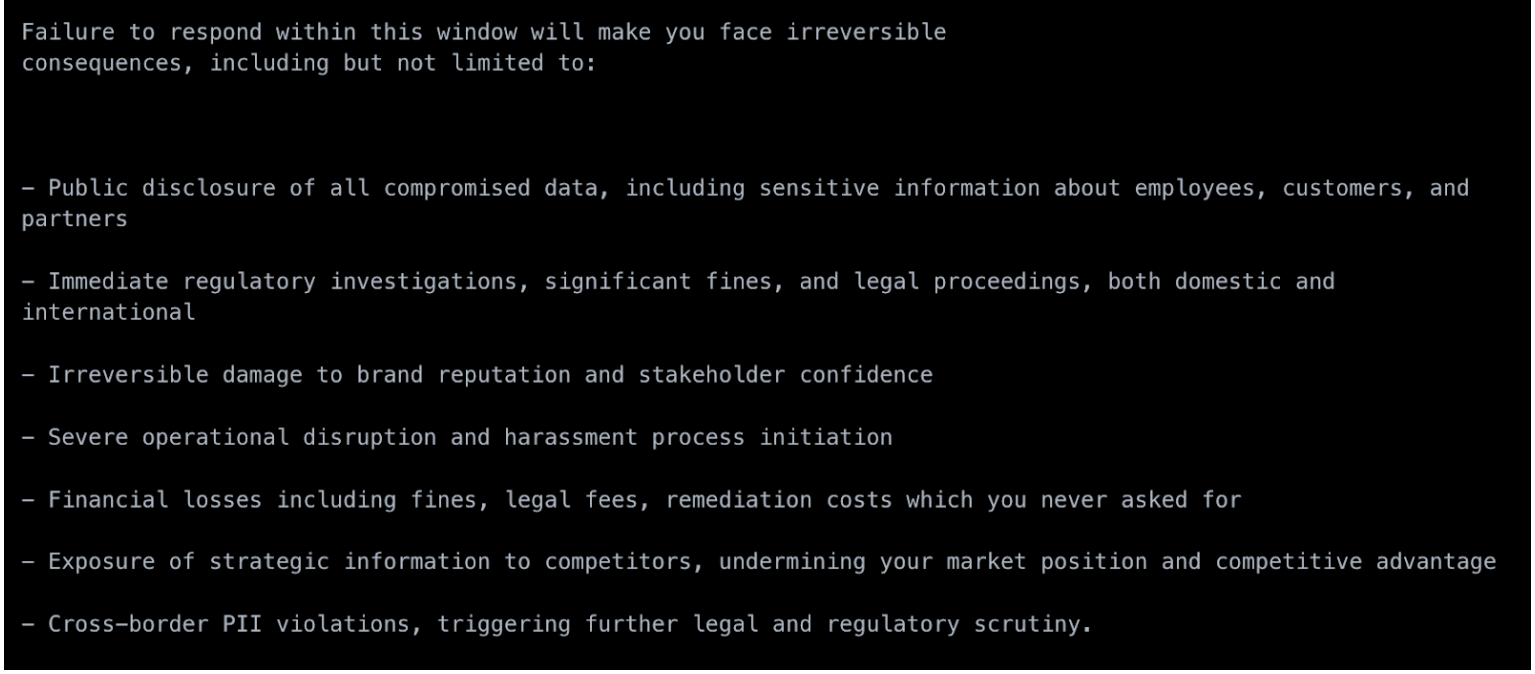


Figure 1: Ransom note extract

Outlook and Implications

This recent incident is similar to prior operations associated with UNC6240, which have frequently used vishing for initial access and have targeted Salesforce data. It does, however, represent an expansion in the number and type of targeted cloud platforms, suggesting that the associated threat actors are modifying their operations to gather more sensitive data for extortion operations. Further, the use of a compromised account to send phishing emails to cryptocurrency-related entities suggests that they may be building relationships with potential victims to expand their access or engage in other follow-on operations.

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